

Q.2a (15 marks): What are the defining characteristics of a scientific discipline, and does Anthropology meet th...



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

Q2. (a) What are the defining characteristics of a scientific discipline, and does Anthropology meet those criteria? (15 marks)

Anthropology is the study of human in various places and time.

The debate of Anthropology being a scientific discipline or a humanities is brought forward by numerous anthropologist time and again.

What are the defining characteristics of a scientific discipline?

- (1) Generates basic laws and theories.
- (2) Based on empirical data.
- (3) Scientific discipline includes various research methodology.
- (4) Based on the principle of Objectivity, Rationality.
- (5) Utility aspect

Does Anthropology meet these criteria?

① Radcliffe-Brown argues that, Anthropology as a discipline core purpose is to generate laws and theories. Many theories like Structuralism, Functionalism

Thus could be said as scientific discipline.

- ② Anthropology utilizes various empirical data from the field. For example Aileen Ross analyzed Bangalore families to know impact of industrialization on joint families.
- ③ Anthropology uses various research methodologies and fieldworks for example Malinowski participant observation among Trobriand Islanders. Similarly research methodologies include case-studies, questionnaire.
- ④ Anthropology make use of cultural data and fields for it's benefit. utility in policy making by Action anthropologist. example Majumdar's data for census

However few anthropologist do not agree in placing anthropology as purely a scientific discipline.

Evan's Pritchard, Margaret Mead calls anthropology more humanists.

- Anthropology allows subjectivity for example Cultural Relativism.

- Anthropology concerns with history (Evan's Pritchard)

Thus Malinowski places anthropology in the middle between scientific and humanity discipline.

Anthropology bring humanities in science and science in humanities.

gives in theory

Ethno-
centrism

views of post modernist

good conclusion

9 1/2